CDM-OBS Table Governance Suggestion Template

Purpose

This document provides a structured process for members of the CDM-OBS governance group to propose edits or additions to the CDM-OBS model tables. The goal is to ensure consistency, clarity, and traceability for all table updates.

Table Change Proposal Template

Contributor Information

- Name:
- Role:
- Contact (GitHub handle/email):

Target Table

- Table file name (from cdm-obs/tables):
- Table description:

Type of Change

Select one or more: - [ ] Correction (typo, value fix) - [ ] New entry addition - [ ] Unit or value update - [ ] Structural change (column rename, new column) - [ ] Metadata enhancement - [ ] Deprecation or retirement - [ ] Other: _____

Current Content (before change)

```
Paste the relevant snippet from the table here.
```

Proposed Content (after change)

```
Show the updated snippet here — formatted clearly.
```

Motivation & Rationale

- Why is this change needed?
- What problem is it solving?
- Applicable references or standards:

Impact Assessment

- Downstream systems affected
- Backward compatibility concerns
- Testing or validation needed

Reviewer Notes / Additional Comments

Example Filled Template

Contributor Information

- **Name:** Simon Noone
- **Role:** Task lead MU
- **Contact:** simon.noone@mu.ie

Target Table

- **Table file name:** `instruments.csv`
- **Table description:** List of observation instruments used in CDM-OBS.

Type of Change

☐ Correction

☒ New entry addition

Current Content (before change)

```
InstrumentID, Name, Type, Wavelength
INS001, MODIS, Radiometer, 0.4-14.0
INS002, AVHRR, Radiometer, 0.55-12.5
```

Proposed Content (after change)

```
InstrumentID, Name, Type, Wavelength
INS001, MODIS, Radiometer, 0.4-14.0
INS002, AVHRR, Radiometer, 0.55-12.5
INS003, VIIRS, Radiometer, 0.41-12.0
```

Motivation & Rationale

- The VIIRS instrument has been increasingly used for operational observation and should be included.
- Reference: NOAA VIIRS Technical Documentation

Impact Assessment

- Tools consuming the `instruments.csv` table need to recognize INS003.
- No backward compatibility issues; existing entries remain unchanged.
- Validation: Confirmed VIIRS wavelength ranges match documentation.

Reviewer Notes / Additional Comments

- Ensure lookups for new instrument.

Submission Instructions

1. Create a GitHub Issue using this template in the CDM-OBS repo.
2. Discuss proposed changes in the issue thread.
3. Submit a Pull Request (PR) referencing the issue once consensus is reached.
4. Include the filled template in the PR description for reviewer context.

How it works

1. **Template is just a starting form**
   - The YAML template created in `.github/EDITS_REQUEST_TEMPLATE` (or `.github/ISSUE_TEMPLATE`) defines **fields, placeholders, and structure**.
   - When a user clicks **"New Issue"** on the repo and selects your template, GitHub generates a **new issue draft** pre-filled with the fields you defined.
2. **User fills in the fields**
   - They enter content into each input, text area, or checkbox in the GitHub web UI.
   - GitHub shows a **preview of the formatted Markdown** before submission.
3. **Submission saves it**
   - The issue **does not save automatically** as you type—it's only created when the user clicks **"Submit new issue"**.
   - Once submitted:
     - A new issue appears in the repo.
     - All the fields from the template are now part of the issue description in Markdown.
     - Other contributors or reviewers can comment, edit, or add attachments as usual.